

Gold — Week Ahead

23 August 2026 to 30 August

What is scheduled, how gold has behaved around those releases historically, and what a given move in rates or the dollar would be worth. **This report does not forecast the gold price** — see the methodology note overleaf.

EXPLAINED BY DRIVERS

28%

of a typical one-month move

UNEXPLAINED BAND

±4.1%

1 s.d. of what drivers miss

GOLD VS DRIVERS, 12M

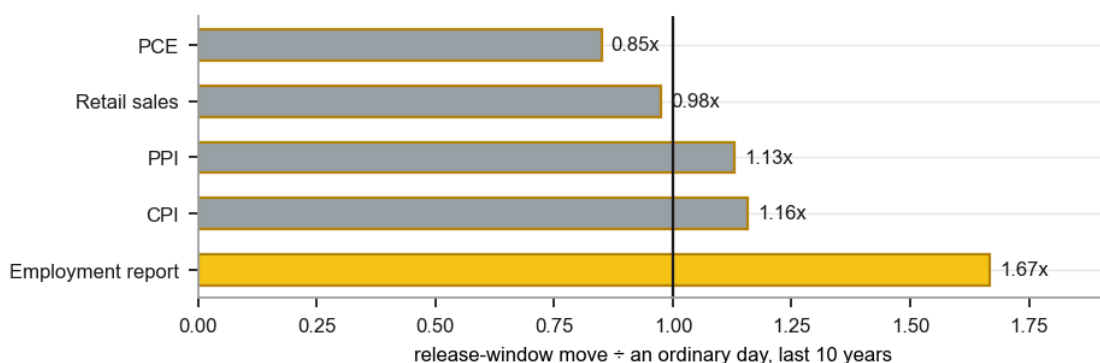
+15.2%

82th percentile of that gap

1 Scheduled this week

Day	Time		Release	Consensus	Previous	Gold's typical reaction
Tue 25 Aug	21:30 ET	AUD	CPI m/m	0.9%	-0.1%	—
Tue 25 Aug	21:30 ET	AUD	CPI y/y	3.3%	3.8%	—
Tue 25 Aug	21:30 ET	AUD	Trimmed Mean CPI m/m	0.3%	0.3%	—
Wed 26 Aug	08:30 ET	USD	Core PCE Price Index m/m	0.2%	0.1%	no measurable premium
Wed 26 Aug	08:30 ET	USD	Prelim GDP q/q	1.5%	1.5%	—
Fri 28 Aug	08:30 ET	CAD	GDP m/m	0.2%	0.3%	—
Fri 28 Aug	10:00 ET	USD	Fed Chairman Warsh Speaks	—	—	—
Fri 28 Aug	10:00 ET	USD	Prelim Benchmark Payrolls Revision	—	-911K	—
Fri 28 Aug	12:15 ET	All	Jackson Hole Symposium	—	—	—

2 What the record actually shows



Release	Last 10y	0-5	5-10	10-15	15-20	20-25	25-30	30-35	Verdict
Employment report	1.67×	1.55	1.70	1.99	1.23	1.29	1.13	0.97	elevated in the last 6, not the earliest
CPI	1.16×	1.28	1.00	0.94	1.07	1.19	0.83	0.98	no consistent premium
PPI	1.13×	1.05	1.24	—	—	—	—	—	too short to judge
Retail sales	0.98×	0.90	1.05	0.92	0.98	0.93	—	—	no consistent premium
PCE	0.85×	0.88	0.82	1.17	0.93	1.18	—	—	no consistent premium

Gold's average absolute move in the release window (London AM to PM fix, which brackets the 08:30 ET print) divided by the same figure on ordinary days matched for year and weekday. Columns are **equal-width, non-overlapping five-year periods counting back from today** — so the leftmost describes the market you are trading now, and each is an independent sample rather than a rolling window of largely the same data.

Contact

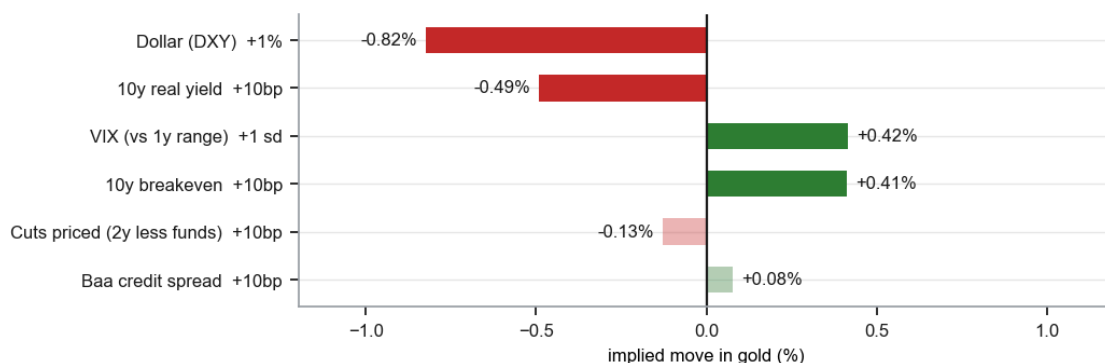
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Read the row, not the number. A relationship that is real barely moves when the period changes; one that wanders was never established, however convincing a single cut looks. **Employment report** carries a premium in every recent period (1.13–1.99×); CPI, Retail sales, PCE wander between 0.82 and 1.28× with no pattern. Only Employment report survives a multiple-comparison correction across the 5 releases tested.

3 What each driver is worth



Driver	Move	Implied gold	t
Dollar (DXY)	+1%	-0.82%	-7.6
10y real yield	+10bp	-0.49%	-4.5
VIX (vs 1y range)	+1 sd	+0.42%	2.3
10y breakeven	+10bp	+0.41%	2.4
Cuts priced (2y less funds)	+10bp	-0.13%	-1.7
Baa credit spread	+10bp	+0.08%	0.5

Fitted jointly on 6,146 daily observations of point-in-time data, with Newey-West standard errors at the one-month horizon. Faded bars in the chart are coefficients that do not clear $|t| = 2$ and should be read as noise.

4 Scenarios

Scenario	Assumes	Implied gold
Dovish	Real yields -20bp, dollar -2%, breakevens +10bp	+3.1% ±4.1%
Hawkish	Real yields +25bp, dollar +2%	-2.8% ±4.1%
Risk-off	VIX +1sd, credit +50bp, real yields -15bp, dollar +1%	+0.7% ±4.1%

Each scenario states its own assumptions; every driver not named is held unchanged rather than set to a historical average. The band is one standard deviation of the move the drivers do *not* explain, and it is wide — larger than most of the scenario effects themselves.

5 The month just gone

Gold moved **+13.28%** over the last 21 trading days. The drivers account for **+3.49%**; the remaining **+9.47%** is not explained by rates, the dollar, credit or risk appetite. Over twelve months that unexplained component now stands at **+15.2%** — the portion of gold's run that the measurable macro drivers do not account for, and the usual candidates for it are official-sector buying and the debasement trade, neither of which this report attempts to quantify.

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Methodology

and what this report does not claim

This report contains no forecast of the gold price. The underlying research tested whether the standard gold drivers — real yields, the dollar, Fed pricing, ETF flows, positioning, official-sector demand and Asian physical premia — can predict gold's direction over 5, 60 and 250 days. Across 21 years, using point-in-time data with no look-ahead, **they cannot**. Every driver that shows a statistically robust relationship with gold moves *at the same time* as gold, not before it, in every volatility and trend regime tested. No model built in that work beat simply holding the metal. What follows is therefore a description of measured relationships and historical behaviour only.

Gold benchmark. LBMA Gold Price PM, USD/oz, the London auction print. A fix is a single auction, not a continuous tradeable price.

Baseline. Ordinary days matched on year and weekday, so a Friday release is compared with other Fridays from the same era.

Sensitivities. Ridge on same-period driver changes; the penalty keeps the collinear rates and dollar block readable. Newey-West errors at one month.

Point-in-time. Every input is read as it stood on the day, including the revision then in force. Macro series carry their true first-release dates.

Release window. London AM to PM fix, which brackets the 08:30 ET release. The 24-hour fix-to-fix measure is weaker and is not shown.

Significance. Stratified permutation test with Holm correction across event types. Absolute returns are not normal, so a t-test would not do.

Exogenous drivers only. ETF tonnage and positioning are excluded — they rise *because* gold rallied as much as the reverse, and including them halves the measured real-yield effect.

Surprise, not measured. No free source carries a history of consensus forecasts, so only the *fact* of a release is known, never whether it surprised. Nothing here conditions on the size or sign of a surprise.

Sources: LBMA (benchmark), FRED and ALFRED (rates, inflation, credit, activity — with full revision history), Yahoo Finance (dollar index, equities), CFTC (positioning), SPDR Gold Trust (ETF tonnage), IMF (official reserves), Shanghai Gold Exchange (Asian premium), FairEconomy (calendar). Built 2026-08-23.

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